Family Support for Children with Disabilities

Family Support Services Agreement
Information for Families



Alberta

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Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD)

About your Family Support Services (FSS) Agreement Information Package

Below is a list of documents provided in your information package about your Family Support Services (FSS) Agreement. Please take time to review each document and contact your Disability Services Worker if you have any questions. We suggest you review the documents in the order that they are numbered.

Note: If you chose to receive your FSS Agreement in the mail for signature, you also received an attachment called:

- Information for Families - Mailed Agreements

This additional document provides important information about your agreement, how you can access services, how to be reimbursed, what records you need to keep and other resources.

Document Name	Description
00. FSCD FSS Checklist for Guardians	Summarizes next steps for guardians after they receive their FSS agreement.
Family Information Package	
01. Title Page	Cover page in the Family Information Package E-Binder.
02. Table of Contents	Listing of items in the Family Information Package E-Binder and the Forms enclosed in the zip file.
03. Information for Parents - Services in your FSS Agreement	Provides an overview of services that can be provided through an FSS Agreement, including guidelines and record keeping requirements for each service.
04. FSCD Agreement Companion Guide	Outlines the legal terms of your agreement.
05. Online Claims Reimbursement Getting Started	Describes how to use online claims reimbursement (OCR), a web portal for families to create, save and submit expense claims to the FSCD program.
06. Guide for Financial Record Keeping 2023	Helps families create, gather and keep the right documents and records to show that FSCD supports and services were received and paid for.
07. Digital Signature Tips for Parents Guardians	Provides information on how to provide a digital signature to sign FSCD agreements.
08. Digital ID Verified Example	An image of what your Alberta.ca account should look like when it is verified.

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09. Family FAQ - Multiyear Agreement	Frequently asked questions (FAQ) and answers about multiyear agreements (up to 3 years) in the FSCD program.
10. Family FAQ - Family Resource Centres	Frequently asked questions and answers about Family Resource Centres and how they can help you find and access disability related services and supports.
11. Family FAQ - Respite	Frequently asked questions and answers about respite support in the FSCD program.
12. Family FAQ - Counselling	Frequently asked questions and answers about counselling services that can be accessed within the FSCD program.
13. Family FAQ - Medical Appointments	Frequently asked questions and answers about medical appointment expenses that can be covered through the FSCD program.
14. Family FAQ - Clothing and Footwear	Frequently asked questions and answers about extraordinary clothing and footwear expenses directly related to a child's disability that can be accessed within the FSCD program.
FSCD Program Forms	
F01. Form - FSCD Application for Electronic Payment	A form that needs to be filled out to have direct deposit set up for reimbursement from the FSCD program.
F02. Self-refer Triple P Referral Form	A form to fill out if you are interested in the Triple P Program.
F03. Form - Confirmation of Medical Appointment or Hospital Stay	A form that needs to be filled out to provide valid proof of services for all approved mileage, parking and meal costs associated with a medical appointment or hospital stay.
F04. Mileage Parking Log	A form that needs to be filled out for the purpose of documenting mileage and parking.
F05. Form - Record of Services Provided	A form that needs to be filled out for the purpose of validating expenses and payments under the FSCD program.

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1. Family Support Services Agreement – Information for Families

The FSCD program can provide some services to your family through a **Family Support Services (FSS) Agreement**. You may receive an FSS Agreement after your eligibility for the FSCD program has been determined and before you complete an assessment of needs.

This document provides an overview of the services that can be provided through an FSS Agreement, including guidelines and record keeping requirements for each service.

If your family has additional needs that cannot be met by an FSS Agreement, you may be assigned to a different FSCD worker who will assess your needs and update your agreement as required.

You can reach out to your FSCD worker at any time if you would like to discuss additional services and supports. If your family has an FSS Agreement, your FSCD worker will also contact you each year to check in and review any changes to your family's needs or circumstances.

Type of Family Support Service (FSS)	Description	Guidelines	Record Keeping Requirements
Respite - in or out of home: Up to 240 hours/year	Funds for guardians to hire staff to temporarily care for their child to provide a break.	You may hire a: • Private person • A community agency that provides respite services • Adult relative, except for a parent, who is 18 years of age or older *(requires FSCD approval)* • Individual who is 16 or 17 years of age who is not a relative Cannot be used when: • The child is normally in school • Guardians are working or attending training or school	You must: • Complete a Record of Services form • Document proof of payment • Keep records of these for 7 years • Provide these records to FSCD upon request
Individual and/or family counselling: Up to 20 hours/year	Funds to access individual or family counselling services from a licensed or registered provider under the *Health Professions Act* to support the family's well-being and strengthen their ability to care for their child.	You must: • Use benefits from any existing health or benefit plans (such as through your employment) before you can be reimbursed for counselling through FSCD. Cannot be used for psychological testing.	You must: • Keep receipts or other validation that you received the counselling service and that you paid for the service • Provide these records to FSCD upon request • Keep records of these for 7 years

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Type of Family Support Service (FSS)	Description	Guidelines	Record Keeping Requirements
Medical Appointment Supports: Up to 36 medical/health professional appointments for your child or when your child is hospitalized The caseworker in conversation with your family, will determine the type, number of units needed for medical support and regional rates.	Assistance with some of the extraordinary costs of your child's disability-related medical appointment, including: • Mileage and public transportation, • Parking, and • Sibling care. For trips over 8 hours, there is also coverage for: • Meals for one adult and one child, and • Accommodations (hotel or Ronald McDonald House) For out-of-province: Costs for mileage, overnight accommodation, transportation, parking, sibling care and meals.	Assistance with some of the costs for meals or accommodations can only be used for day trips over 8 hours to attend medical-related appointments or when the child is in hospital. • You cannot claim reimbursement for meals for your child when they are in the hospital. Alberta Health must approve out-of-province medical trips.	You must: • Complete the Confirmation of Medical Appointment/Hospital Stay Form • Keep records for mileage and receipts for other expenses (such as accommodations, parking and meals) for 7 years • Provide these records to FSCD upon request
Clothing and Footwear: Up to $400/year	Assistance with some of the **extraordinary** costs of clothing and footwear directly related to the child's disability.	Parents are responsible for their child's typical clothing and footwear expenses.	You must: • Keep receipts or other validation for 7 years • Provide them to FSCD upon request

Note: These rules may change periodically based on updates made to the FSCD Policy and Procedures Manual.

Triple P Program

In addition to the services listed above, families may also choose to access Triple P through their FSS Agreement.

- All families in Alberta can access Triple P resources, including the online Triple P course, free of charge. Visit the Triple P website to learn more.
- Triple P also offers a course called Stepping Stones Triple P, designed for parents of children with disabilities.
    - Stepping Stones Triple P is not available through the Triple P website.
    - To access Stepping Stones, families will need to complete the Stepping Stones Triple P Referral Form (attached in a family's FSS information package) and return it with their agreement to the FSCD office by mail or by email to the FSCD office closest to them.

Other Resources

- If you would like more information about the FSCD program, including hiring service providers, visit our website or call us toll-free at **1-888-278-7088** (voicemail line only).
- For information about submitting claims to FSCD for reimbursement, visit Online Claims Reimbursement.
- If you need assistance with finding a respite provider, please contact a Family Resource Centre for support.
- More FSCD resources including information about FSCD Record Keeping Requirements are available here.

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2. Tip Sheet: Understanding your FSCD Agreement

Your Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD) Agreement is a legal document that identifies the supports and services to be provided and explains details about how the supports and services can be provided.

The legal terms of your agreement are described below:

Background, Definitions and Term of Agreement: States the name of your child who the services are for and the legislation that allows for this agreement to be made. Terms that are used within the agreement are defined and explained in this section. The term of the agreement is the start date and end date for the agreement. The term may be up to three years.

Funding and Services: States the total cost of the services in the agreement. The Government of Alberta (GOA) agrees to provide the funding for services as long as public funds are available. If you do not use the funds as outlined in the agreement, you must return the amount within 30 days of being informed by the Director. If you provide false, misleading, or inaccurate information to get funding or services, you may face civil action or criminal charges. You are responsible for all costs normally associated with providing everyday care for the child, including accessing any benefits that are available.

Invoicing, Records and Monitoring: You can invoice for services provided each month. You must keep and maintain records for a period of seven (7) years. Upon request, you will be required to provide the records to the FSCD program for review. All information and records in the custody or under the control of the Minister are subject to the *Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act* (FOIP).

Employment Matters: You agree to directly employ staff or contract with a service provider agency to deliver the services in your agreement. Guardians choose, hire or contract, and monitor their staff and service providers to make sure they are working toward achieving identified goals and are fulfilling their responsibilities. The GOA is NOT the employer.

Guardians either "employ" staff or "contract" with their service providers of choice. This relationship is determined by the Canada Revenue Agency (CRA). You will also need to ensure that the laws and standards as set out in the Employment Standards Code (Alberta), the *Workers' Compensation Act* (Alberta) and adhere to all related regulations and CRA requirements. Find out more information on the CRA online at www.cra-arc.gc.ca.

Insurance, Indemnity and Hold Harmless: Employers need to be aware of and protect themselves against the risk of any liability issues that may come with hiring staff or contracting service providers. As a guardian who is party to a FSCD Agreement, you may be acting as an employer and should be informed of your role and responsibilities as an employer. You could be liable for third party claims, demands, actions or costs that arise from negligent or willful acts you, your staff or your service providers commit. The GOA is unable to provide any protection in the form of insurance coverage or costs associated with any legal claim against a Guardian that may arise from this agreement. It is highly recommended that Guardians contact their personal insurance provider regarding their homeowner policy and options for legal liability insurance.

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Legal Action: If there is legal action related to your child's disability in the past or in the future, you will notify the FSCD program and future costs for services may be considered or potentially sought in the legal action.

Termination: The Guardian or Director can end the agreement at any time if both parties agree. However, if there is not a mutual agreement, then either party will need to provide 30 days' notice of termination in writing. There will be no reimbursement for services delivered after the date of termination.

General: Once an agreement is signed, any agreements or decisions made about the supports and services provided to your child made prior to the signing of the agreement are no longer valid. The legal agreement can be changed in writing, if both the Guardian and Director are in agreement.

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3. Family Support Services Agreement – Mailed Agreement

Information for Families - Mailed Agreement

Welcome to the Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD) program. We are sharing this email to inform you that your child is eligible for the FSCD program. An agreement for **Family Support Services (FSS)** will be sent to you by mail in the next few weeks for your signature.

This email is not your agreement, but includes important information about your agreement, how you can access services, how to be reimbursed, what records you need to keep and other resources.

Signing your FSS Agreement

You will need to:

1. **Review**
2. **Sign** and
3. **Return your signed agreement** to the FSCD office closest to you before you can start accessing or be reimbursed for any services in your agreement.

Our FSCD Agreement Companion Guide is included in your information package. This guide will help you understand the terms in your agreement.

After you Sign and Return your FSS Agreement

You will receive a final copy signed by the FSCD Director for your records.

Once you receive the final copy of your agreement you can start to access services. Make sure you review the Family Support for Children with Disabilities: Tip Sheet and Family Guide for Financial Record-Keeping, which is also included in your information package.

Getting Reimbursed for Services

You must submit claims to be reimbursed for services.

Direct Deposit

You can be reimbursed directly to your bank account for claims submitted through a process called Online Claims Reimbursement (see below), by email, or by mail, but the first step is to set up your direct deposit.

Please complete the Government of Alberta's direct deposit form (included with your information package) **and** attach a pre-printed VOID cheque from your bank/financial institution.

You can return this by mailing it with your signed agreement, or emailing a scanned copy to us at: SCSS.FSCDFamilySupportServicesTeam@gov.ab.ca

Make sure to write 'VOID' across the cheque. It must also include your:

- Name
- Current address
- Bank account number

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4. Online Claims Reimbursement

Online Claims Reimbursement (OCR) is the quickest, easiest, and preferred method to submit your claims for reimbursement for the services you use in your agreement. Using OCR allows you to electronically submit your claims and have the funds directly deposited to your account. Please review the FSCD OCR Getting Started Tip Sheet.

To use OCR, you will need to set up a verified Alberta.ca Account. This account gives you seamless access to a growing range of government services, while protecting your information and privacy. This account will enable you to:

- Create and send FSCD invoices to the FSCD program through the OCR site (demonstration videos can be found here).
- Receive and sign your agreements digitally (tip sheet can be found here and demonstration video can be found here).

More information about Alberta.ca accounts can be found here.

If you have questions or need assistance with your setting up your account, please:

- Visit Alberta.ca Account - Contact,
- Contact Alberta Supports or
- Contact a Family Resource Centre.

Family Resource Centres can assist you with submitting claims through OCR.

Submitting Claims by Email or Mail

If you are not able to use OCR, you can submit by email.

If neither of these two options are possible for you, please submit them by mail. The forms required for submitting claims by email or mail and instructions are included in your information package:

- **Statement of Expense form,** and
- **Record of Services Provided form**

Completed forms must be returned to an FSCD office to be processed.

Questions about your Agreement?

FSCD offices are available across the province. FSCD office contact information and mailing addresses can be found here.

Come into an office, call **1-888-278-7088** (voicemail line only), or email to get help accessing the FSCD services you need.

Need help understanding this information or finding a respite provider?

Family Resource Centres assist individuals with disabilities and their families with accessing and navigating the variety of disability supports and services available in Alberta. Staff at Family Resource Centres can assist families who manage their own services through the FSCD program.

Family Resource Centres provide tools, resources, and information to help families manage their FSCD services. This includes support with things like hiring staff and administration.

For more information, see the Family Resource Centres webpage on Alberta.ca.

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Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD)

Getting Started

Online Claims Reimbursement (OCR)

What Is OCR?

A secure, web-based portal for families to create, save and submit expense claims to the FSCD program for reimbursement.

OCR makes it easier and faster to receive reimbursement from the FSCD program.

What Do You Need?

- ✓ A smartphone, tablet, laptop, or desktop computer.
- ✓ An internet connection using a browser such as Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge or Fire Fox.
- ✓ An active email account.
- ✓ A current active FSCD agreement.
- ✓ A vendor/business partner number already set up by FSCD staff.

Creating & Managing Your Account

- ✓ Go to https://ocr.alberta.ca
- ✓ Click on "Sign in".
- ✓ Set up your secure ID.
- ✓ Log into the OCR portal using your username and password.

Enrolling Your Child

The six pieces of information required to enroll each child include:

- ✓ the child's FSCD file number;
- ✓ child's date of birth;
- ✓ guardian's first and last name as it reads on the FSCD agreement; and
- ✓ the start and end dates of the child's current FSCD agreement.

Get Started Today

https://ocr.alberta.ca

alberta.ca

June 2022

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5. Family Guide for Financial Record Keeping

Family Support for Children with Disabilities

Family Guide for Financial Record-Keeping

Alberta

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Purpose

The purpose of this guide is to help families create, gather and keep the right documents and records to show that Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD) supports and services were received and paid for as intended. This is important as families are required to keep this information and provide it if requested (under the *Family Support for Children with Disabilities Act* and the *Financial Administration Act*).

If you have any questions about this guide or are experiencing challenges, you are encouraged to reach out to a financial administration worker with the FSCD program for help.

Background

The FSCD program is a reimbursement program regionally administered by the Government of Alberta. To align with Canada Revenue Agency financial record keeping requirements, financial records for FSCD agreements are required to be kept for seven (7) years.

"Records" means any documents, information, records or materials, regardless of form, which are made, generated, produced or acquired as a result of this Agreement by the Guardian, Staff, Service Providers and any other of the Guardian's employees, contractors, subcontractors or agents.

Required records to support reimbursement

For each reimbursement claim submitted, it is important to have the following documentation:

- **A.** Proof of claim submission;
- **B.** Proof of goods or services received; and
- **C.** Proof of payment.

This guide explains, with examples, what qualifies as proof of goods or services received and payment.

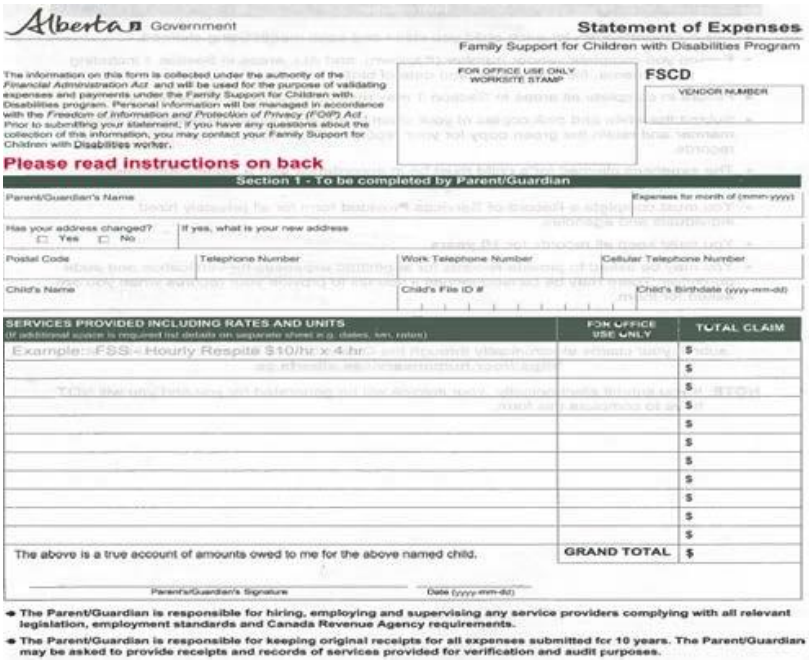
Often, a receipt can serve as both proof of goods or services received and payment. More information is available on page 8.

A. Proof of claim submission

To be reimbursed for goods and services outlined in their FSCD agreement, guardians must submit manual "Statement of Expenses" forms **or** submit claims electronically through the Online Claims Reimbursement (OCR) site. Guardians must keep a copy of the Statement of Expenses and/or the invoice generated by the OCR site for each claim they submit to the FSCD program.

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FSCD STATEMENT OF EXPENSES FORM



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Statement of Expenses

Family Support for Children with Disabilities Program

The information on this form is collected under the authority of the *Financial Administration Act* and will be used for the purpose of validating expenses and payments under the Family Support for Children with Disabilities program. Personal information will be managed in accordance with the *Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy (FOIP) Act*. Prior to submitting your statement, if you have any questions about the collection of this information, you may contact your Family Support for Children with Disabilities worker.

FOR OFFICE USE ONLY WORKSITE STAMP

FSCD

VENDOR NUMBER

Please read instructions on back

Section 1 - To be completed by Parent/Guardian

Parent/Guardian's Name | Expenses for month of (mmm-yyyy)

Has your address changed? ☐ Yes ☐ No | If yes, what is your new address

Postal Code | Telephone Number | Work Telephone Number | Cellular Telephone Number

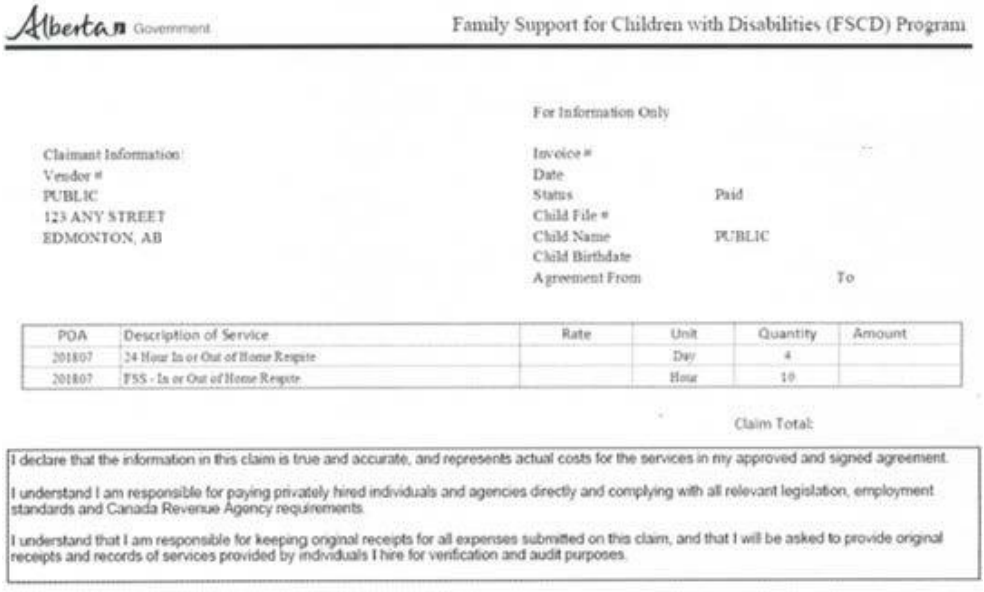
Child's Name | Child's File ID # | Child's Birthdate (yyyy-mm-dd)

SERVICES PROVIDED INCLUDING RATES AND UNITS (If additional space is required list details on separate sheet e.g. dates, km, rates)	FOR OFFICE USE ONLY	TOTAL CLAIM
Example: FSS - Hourly Respite $10/hr x 4 hr		$
		$
		$
		$
		$
		$
		$
		$
		$
		$
		$
The above is a true account of amounts owed to me for the above named child.	GRAND TOTAL	$

Parent/Guardian's Signature | Date (yyyy-mm-dd)

- **The Parent/Guardian is responsible for hiring, employing and supervising any service providers complying with all relevant legislation, employment standards and Canada Revenue Agency requirements.**
- **The Parent/Guardian is responsible for keeping original receipts for all expenses submitted for 10 years. The Parent/Guardian may be asked to provide receipts and records of services provided for verification and audit purposes.**

FSCD Online Claims Reimbursement Invoice



Alberta Government

Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD) Program

For Information Only

Claimant Information
Vendor #
PUBLIC
123 ANY STREET
EDMONTON, AB

Invoice #
Date
Status Paid
Child File #
Child Name PUBLIC
Child Birthdate
Agreement From To

POA	Description of Service	Rate	Unit	Quantity	Amount
201807	24 Hour In or Out of Home Respite		Day	4	
201807	FSS - In or Out of Home Respite		Hour	10	

Claim Total:

I declare that the information in this claim is true and accurate, and represents actual costs for the services in my approved and signed agreement.

I understand I am responsible for paying privately hired individuals and agencies directly and complying with all relevant legislation, employment standards and Canada Revenue Agency requirements.

I understand that I am responsible for keeping original receipts for all expenses submitted on this claim, and that I will be asked to provide original receipts and records of services provided by individuals I hire for verification and audit purposes.

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B. Proof of goods or services received

The supports and services families may access are detailed in their agreement and fall within two categories: 'goods' and 'services.'

Goods are objects or things that families may purchase, such as clothing and footwear, prescription formula, extended health care coverage, etc.

Services involve paying people to work directly with you or your child—such as respite, aide supports, specialized services or counselling. Services you receive may be provided by an agency or business, or by individuals you hire yourself (private provider).

Proof of goods or services received may come in different formats such as a receipt, an invoice from an agency or business or an FSCD Record of Services Provided form. Regardless of the format, valid proof that goods or services were received must include the following information:

- name of business, agency or individual providing the goods or services;
- the date and times the goods or services were provided; • the type of goods or services provided; and
- the rate or cost of the goods or services.

Examples of valid proof of goods or services received:

1. Receipt

When you buy something, you will get a point of sale business receipt. This format is best when the items you are being reimbursed for are goods (for example, prescription formula). It includes:

- name of business – e.g. *name of pharmacy*
- the date provided (in this case purchased)
- the type of goods or services provided – e.g. *name of prescription formula*
- the rate or cost of the goods or services – *cost of item*

Retail receipts may also serve as proof of payment. More information on proof of payment is on page 9.

2. Invoice

An invoice is best when receiving services from a business or agency. It should include:

- the agency name – e.g. Respite Agency [name]
- the date and times of services provided
- the type of services provided – e.g. respite
- the rate of the services – e.g. $x per hour



Respite Agency [name]

INVOICE

Agency's Street Address,
City, Province, Postal Code
Phone

INVOICE # 000
DATE: DATE

TO:
Your Name
Your Address
Your City, Province, Postal Code
Your Phone

SHIP TO:
Your Name
Your Address
Your City, Province, Postal Code
Your Phone

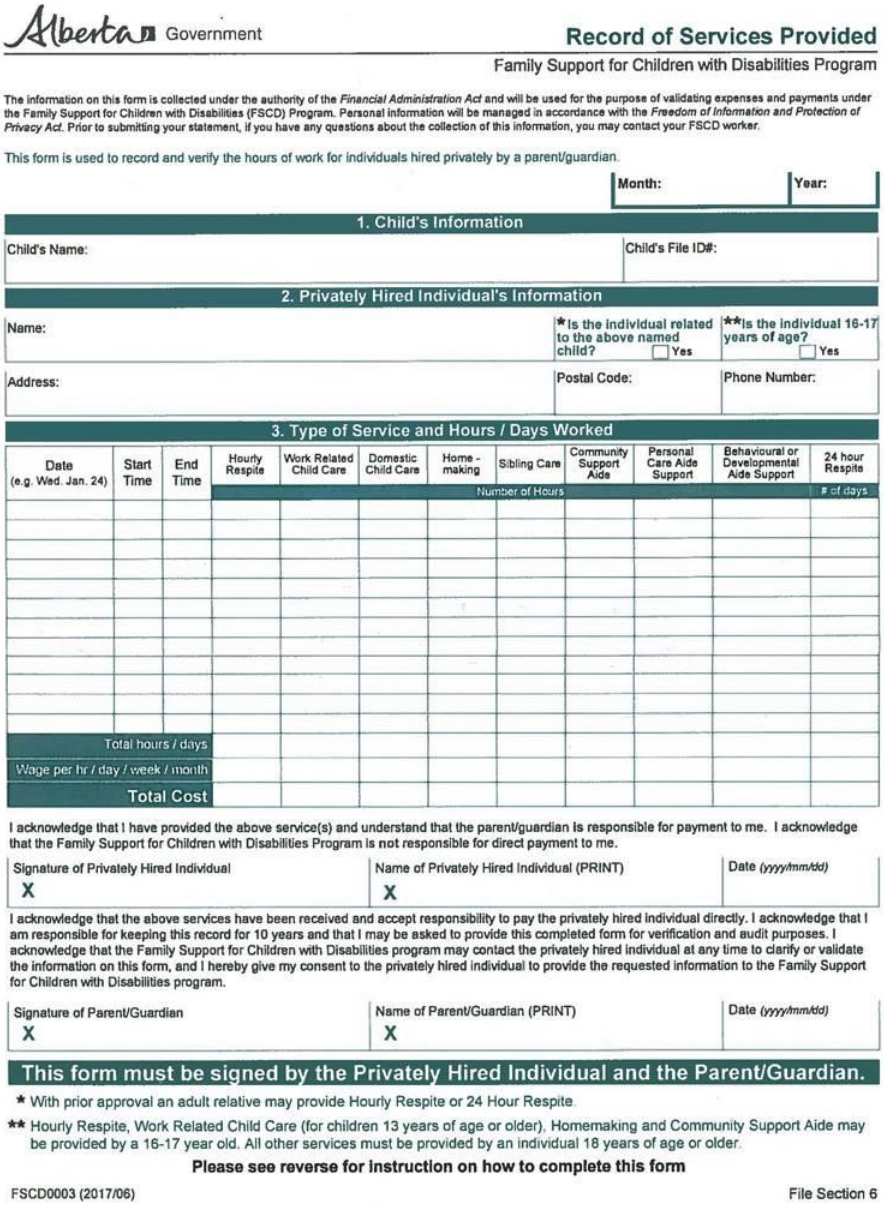
QUANTITY	DESCRIPTION	UNIT PRICE	TOTAL
		SUBTOTAL	
		TAX	
		TOTAL DUE	

Invoices with a confirmation of payment indicated on the invoice also serve as proof of payment. Confirmation of payment could be a paid stamp and the signature or initial of the provider. More information on proof of payment is on page 9 and 10.

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FSCD Record of Services Provided form

A completed **FSCD Record of Services Provided** form contains all necessary proof of service elements and is the preferred method of documentation when guardians are hiring private service providers.



Alberta Government

Record of Services Provided

Family Support for Children with Disabilities Program

The information on this form is collected under the authority of the *Financial Administration Act* and will be used for the purpose of validating expenses and payments under the Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD) Program. Personal information will be managed in accordance with the *Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act*. Prior to submitting your statement, if you have any questions about the collection of this information, you may contact your FSCD worker.

This form is used to record and verify the hours of work for individuals hired privately by a parent/guardian.

Month: | Year:

1. Child's Information

Child's Name: | Child's File ID#:

2. Privately Hired Individual's Information

Name: | *Is the individual related to the above named child? ☐ Yes | **Is the individual 16-17 years of age? ☐ Yes

Address: | Postal Code: | Phone Number:

3. Type of Service and Hours / Days Worked

Date (e.g. Wed. Jan. 24)	Start Time	End Time	Hourly Respite	Work Related Child Care	Domestic Child Care	Home - making	Sibling Care	Community Support Aide	Personal Care Aide Support	Behavioural or Developmental Aide Support	24 hour Respite
			Number of Hours								# of days
Total hours / days											
Wage per hr / day / week / month											
Total Cost											

I acknowledge that I have provided the above service(s) and understand that the parent/guardian is responsible for payment to me. I acknowledge that the Family Support for Children with Disabilities Program is not responsible for direct payment to me.

Signature of Privately Hired Individual: X | Name of Privately Hired Individual (PRINT): X | Date (yyyy/mm/dd)

I acknowledge that the above services have been received and accept responsibility to pay the privately hired individual directly. I acknowledge that I am responsible for keeping this record for 10 years and that I may be asked to provide this completed form for verification and audit purposes. I acknowledge that the Family Support for Children with Disabilities program may contact the privately hired individual at any time to clarify or validate the information on this form, and I hereby give my consent to the privately hired individual to provide the requested information to the Family Support for Children with Disabilities program.

Signature of Parent/Guardian: X | Name of Parent/Guardian (PRINT): X | Date (yyyy/mm/dd)

This form must be signed by the Privately Hired Individual and the Parent/Guardian.

* With prior approval an adult relative may provide Hourly Respite or 24 Hour Respite.

** Hourly Respite, Work Related Child Care (for children 13 years of age or older), Homemaking and Community Support Aide may be provided by a 16-17 year old. All other services must be provided by an individual 18 years of age or older.

Please see reverse for instruction on how to complete this form

FSCD0003 (2017/06) | File Section 6

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C. Proof of payment for goods or services

A proof of payment is a document that supports the exchange of money for goods or services. Proof of payment must contain the following information:

- name of business, agency, or staff providing the goods or services
- the date the goods or services were paid for
- the amount paid

The following examples are common types of proof of payment:

1. Receipt

A point of sale business receipt format is best when the item being reimbursed for are goods. It includes:

- name of business;
- the date the goods or services were provided or purchased;
- the type of goods or services provided; and
- confirmation of payment.

2. Electronic payments

Electronic payments include payments made by debit card, credit card and e-transfer.
These payment methods provide a high level of accountability since they are generated from automated processes and contain information specific to the claim submitted.

For electronic payments, one of the examples below would be appropriate to satisfy the proof of payment requirement.
Either print or take a screenshot of the information below. a)

E-Transfer:

- guardian name should match name on e-transfer receipt;
- name of the provider should match the Record of Services Provided form;
- the payment date and payment amount should align with the Statement of Expense or OCR invoice period of assistance (month/year);
- the confirmation provided should indicate “successfully deposited;” and
- the message (entered by the family) should align with the Statement of Expense or OCR invoice information and should clearly link the receipt to the payment as a matter of best practice.

Classification: Protected A



Credit or debit card payment screenshot

- name of the provider should match the Record of Services Provided form
- the payment date and amount should align with the Statement of Expense or OCR invoice details.

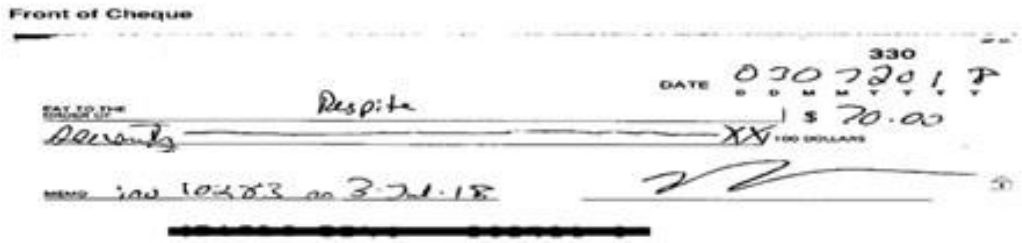


Cheque payments

A cancelled cheque is the only valid proof of payment for this payment type.

- guardian name and contact information should match
- the name of the provider being paid should match the Record of Services Provided form
- payment date and amount should align with the Statement of Expense or OCR invoice period of assistance (month/year)
- it is best to clearly link the Statement of Expense or OCR invoice to the payment
- the back of the cheque must also be provided because this is evidence it was processed

It is good practice to print or save a copy of your cancelled cheque as soon as it is available online, or to check with your bank to find out how long online copies are available. Your bank may allow only a limited amount of time for you to have online access to a copy of a cancelled cheque.



Classification: Protected A

Cash payments

Cash payments are the most difficult in terms of demonstrating eligible and accountable payments as the source and timing of cash payments are not recorded or linked to a specific invoice. For this reason, it is recommended that cash should not be used to pay expenses of more than $100 in a given month. ***It is preferable to use e-transfers or cheques instead of cash payments.***

If cash payments are used you will require a receipt of payment. When paying for services provided by a private service provider the receipt must contain the following information:

- your name
- name of the service provider
- contact information of the private provider (e-mail or phone number)
- the date of payment
- the amount paid
- the signature of the service provider

SAMPLE RECEIPT OF PAYMENT

RECEIPT

PAID BY: PRINT Your Name _____

PAID TO: PRINT Name of the service provider _____

Phone Number _____ and/or email _____

Amount Received $_____ Service Provided _____

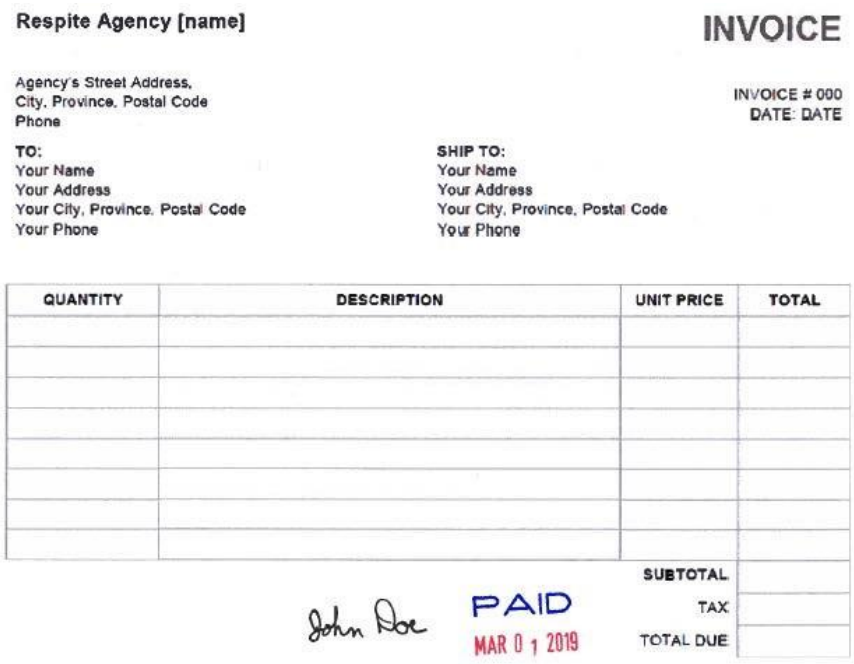
_____ _____

Signature of the service provider Date

Classification: Protected A

Invoice with confirmation of payment

An invoice detailing the goods or services received, dates of service and confirmation of payment indicated on the invoice. Confirmation of payment could be a paid stamp and the signature/initial of the provider.



Respite Agency [name]

INVOICE

Agency's Street Address,
City, Province, Postal Code
Phone

INVOICE # 000
DATE: DATE

TO:
Your Name
Your Address
Your City, Province, Postal Code
Your Phone

SHIP TO:
Your Name
Your Address
Your City, Province, Postal Code
Your Phone

QUANTITY	DESCRIPTION	UNIT PRICE	TOTAL
		SUBTOTAL	
		TAX	
		TOTAL DUE	

John Doe PAID MAR 0 1 2019

Classification: Protected A

6. Disability-related medical appointments (including meals, mileage and parking expenses)

Proof that the child attended a medical appointment can serve as both proof of services received and proof of payment when claiming meal, mileage and parking expenses associated with the appointment.

Other costs associated with a medical appointment, such as accommodations or groceries when staying overnight, still require both proof of service and payment as described above.

Proof that the child attended a medical appointment can come in the form of a completed Confirmation of Medical Appointment/Hospital Stay Form, or a note indicating the child was seen at the medical appointment that includes:

- the name and address of medical provider;
- the time and date of appointment; and
- certification from the medical provider or office staff (such as signature, initial or stamp) that the family attended the appointment.

CONFIRMATION OF MEDICAL APPOINTMENT/HOSPITAL STAY FORM:

Alberta

Confirmation of Medical Appointment/Hospital Stay

Protected A (when completed)

Family Support for Children with Disabilities

FSCD requires proof of attendance for reimbursing travel expenses for medical appointments. This form serves as a valid proof of service for all approved mileage, parking and meal costs associated with a visit. Separate receipts are required for any accommodation costs.

Instruction: Please have a staff person date and sign the form below confirming your attendance and file with your other receipts, invoices and Statements of Expense (SOE) forms so that it is available upon request.

Child's Last Name	Child's First Name

FSCD Child Number	Appointments attended for the month/year of

Name of Medical Professional or Hospital	Date of Appointment yyyy-mm-dd	Time of Appointment

Date yyyy-mm-dd

Signature from Medical Office or Hospital

Privacy

Guardians can black out (i.e. mark over with a black marker/pen) or remove non-required personal information from their documents for privacy and security reasons. Information that will affect the ability to determine that the reimbursement is valid should not be removed.

7. Digital Signature

FSCD Agreement Digital Signature

Tips for parents and guardians

What's happening?

Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD) is offering parents and guardians (guardians) the ability to sign FSCD agreements and amendments (agreements) digitally if they choose. Digital signatures allow guardians to quickly and easily approve their agreements securely from home.

What do I need to sign the agreement digitally?

You require a **verified** Alberta.ca account (formerly MADI) to sign digitally. You may already have a basic account if you use the FSCD Online Claims Reimbursement (OCR) portal. You will also need a mobile device or computer with Internet access.



Alberta

Signature Needed

Your Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD) agreement/amendment is ready for your approval.

Your signature is required to activate the service(s). Please click the *View and sign* button to login to your verified account and sign the document. If you have any questions about the services in your agreement, please contact your FSCD Caseworker.

View and sign document →

Verified account required to sign

A verified Alberta.ca (MADI) account is required to login and sign the agreement. Your Alberta.ca account is a secure way to verify who you are online that is safe, secure and backed by the Government of Alberta. Verifying your identity helps protect your privacy and security. If you do not have an Alberta.ca account yet, you will have the opportunity to create an account. To learn more about Alberta.ca, including how to get your basic account verified, read the Common Questions.

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Alberta

Example email

How does the digital signature work?

1. Your caseworker will ask if you want to sign your new agreement digitally.
2. If you say "yes" you will receive an email inviting you to sign your agreement.
3. Clicking the link will take you to the login page.
4. Once you login to Alberta.ca, you will be able to review your agreement and sign it digitally.
5. You will receive an email confirmation after you have signed successfully.
6. Once the guardian(s) and FSCD director have signed your agreement, you will receive an email with a link to your approved agreement. You will be able to download a copy and/or print a hardcopy for your records. You can watch the digital signature video to see how it works.

Are there any advantages to the digital signature?

Yes, in most cases the digital signature process is faster, because it eliminates mail delivery delays. It may also be more convenient since you will not need to print, scan and mail or email your agreement back.

Classification: Protected A

Why do I need a verified account to sign digitally?

Signatures provide proof the signer is who they say they are and that they agree to the contents of the document. A verified account provides proof of the signer's identity, which helps ensure only authorized guardians can view and sign agreements.

How do I verify my account?

1. Create a basic Alberta.ca account.
2. Click the "Verify Account" button.
3. Provide information from your Driver's License or another accepted identification card.
4. Once you confirm your identification, Alberta.ca will mail an activation code to your home address. This usually takes around 10 days.
5. Once you receive your verification code, login to your basic Alberta.ca account and enter the verification code to verify your account. For more information about Alberta.ca and verifying your account, read these common questions.

What if I can't remember if my Alberta.ca account is verified?

You would have received an activation code by mail to verify your account. Another easy way to check is to login to https://account.alberta.ca. Your account will either say "Verified" or it will offer you the opportunity to verify.

What if I have difficulty creating or verifying my account?

Read these common questions or call the help desk, weekdays, at 1-844-643-2789.

What if I prefer not to sign my agreement digitally?

The digital signature is an option. You can sign your agreement in ink if you prefer. Please discuss your preferences with your caseworker while you are discussing your agreement.

Will I receive a copy of the agreement for my records?

Yes, once your agreement is approved, you will receive an email with a link to your agreement. You will have 30 days to download and/or print a copy of your agreement for your records. FSCD also retains a copy for their records. You can ask your caseworker for a copy if you lose your copy.

Can I use my phone or tablet to sign the agreement?

Yes, Android or Apple (iOS), or Windows.

What does the digital signature software look like?

Please watch the digital signature demonstration video to learn more.

What is an Alberta.ca account?

Alberta.ca provides you with a safe way to identify yourself to government online. An account provides you with a unique online identity so that you have secure access to multiple government programs and services. It is free to create and grants access to participating online government services.

What can I use my Alberta.ca account for?

Besides signing your FSCD agreement, your verified Alberta.ca account allows you to securely access your health records or federal government services, apply for post-secondary scholarships and programs, pay fines and for government services, file employment standards and occupational health and safety complaints, qualify your service dog, get emergency food benefits, apply for senior benefits, and apply for financial assistance.

What if we only want one guardian to sign?

Yes, you can do this. Please speak to your caseworker about your preference. The guardian who is enrolled in the Online Claims Reimbursement (OCR) system should be the one listed on the agreement. A guardian who is not listed on the agreement will not be able to see the agreement services in OCR. All guardians listed on the agreement must sign and so any guardian who does not want to sign will not be listed on the agreement.

What if I did not receive the email to sign my agreement?

If you believe that you have not received the email, check your Junk email folder. After that, contact your caseworker and they will resend the email or discuss other arrangements to sign your agreement.

I've received my approved agreement, but I can't see the services in OCR. Why?

OCR is updated overnight. You should be able to see the services the day after you receive your approved agreement.

I was reviewing my agreement and it is now asking me to login with my Government of Alberta account. What should I do?

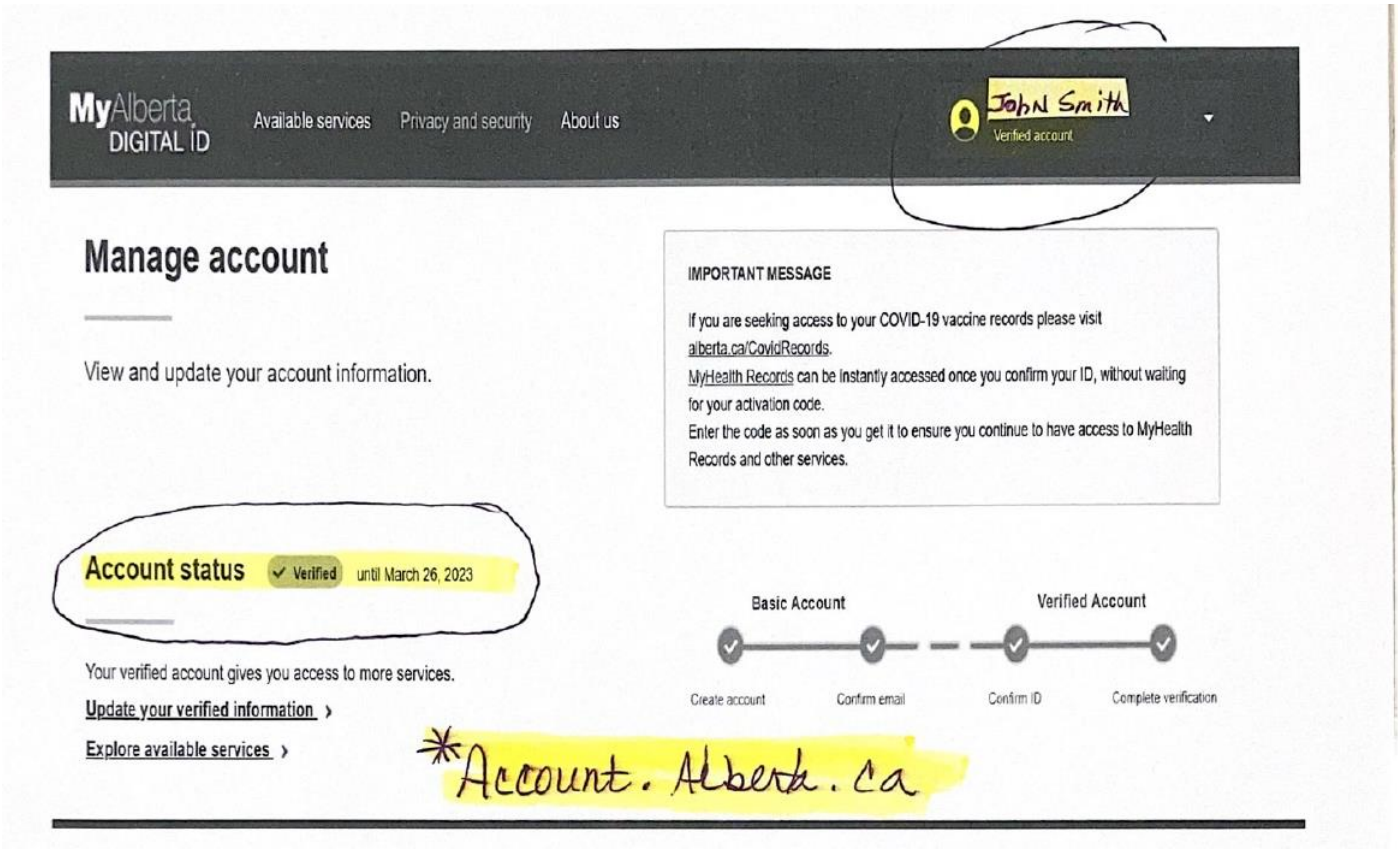
The agreement review window times out after 30 minutes and takes you to a Government of Alberta login screen. Close the window, go back to the email you received, click the review agreement button, login to your verified account and you will be able to review the agreement again.

What if I have difficulty with my digital signature?

The Notarius support centre offers frequently asked questions. If the support centre is unable to resolve your issue, please contact your caseworker or your local FSCD office.

What if I have questions about my agreement?

Please contact your caseworker if you have questions.



Classification: Protected A

8. FAQ – Multiyear Agreements

What are Multi-Year Agreements?

FSCD can provide multi-year agreements with a term of up to three years.

If the guardian is awaiting a diagnosis for their child, a multi-year agreement with a term for up to two years may be provided.

A multi-year agreement may be helpful in supporting your family with longer-term planning and to coordinate your services. Benefits to your family may include:

- reduced administrative burden
- greater stability, continuity and consistency in services and support planning

Families can contact their FSCD worker at any time within the term of their agreement to discuss their needs or changes in circumstance.

What is Considered for a Multi-Year Agreement?

An FSCD worker will work with your family to determine the length of the agreement. The term of the agreement considers whether there are likely to be significant changes in your child's and/or family's life (for example, if your child is starting grade one).

Can I change my Agreement?

Yes. Multi-year agreements can be amended to reflect any changes to your child's or family's needs. Contact your FSCD worker if you want to discuss changes to your multiyear agreement.

Where Can My Family Get More Information?

Family Resource Centres are available to help families manage all aspects of their FSCD Agreement and services. Contact a Family Resource Centre if you would like more information about multi-year agreements.

Classification: Protected A

9. FAQ – Family Resource Centres

What is a Family Resource Centre?

Family Resource Centres (FRCs) are available to help you find and access disability related services and supports in your community.

How can an FRC help my family?

FRCs provide support, tools, training and resources to help families manage their Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD) and Persons with Developmental Disabilities (PDD) services. Here are some examples of what FRCs can help with:

- finding and hiring staff
- managing FSCD or PDD funding, employer responsibilities and financial documentation
- presentations and workshops on a variety of topics
- sharing disability related resources
- sharing information and helping you apply for Registered Disability Savings Plans (RDSP)
- connecting you to other families and your community



Do I need a referral from my worker to access an FRC?

You do not need a referral from your worker to access an FRC and there is no cost to access FRC services. You can call by phone or connect with an FRC online through the linked agency websites on this page.

Does my family member need to have a specific diagnosis to access an FRC?

FRCs are available to all people with disabilities and their families across Alberta – they are not diagnosis specific.

Where can I find an FRC?

There are FRCs in different communities across Alberta. See below and contact the FRC nearest your home community, including if you live in a rural location.
FRCs provide services virtually through phone and online channels.

Easter Seals Alberta Society	Calgary and Southern Alberta	1-877-732-7837
Gateway Association	Edmonton	780-454-0701
Steps Society	Central Alberta	1-877-646-6249
Taproot Community Support Services	Northeast and Northwest Alberta	1-800-867-1987

Classification: Protected A

10. FAQ – Respite Support

What is Respite? How Do I Know If It Is Right for Our Family?

Respite supports are intended to temporarily relieve parents and guardians from the full care and supervision demands of their child with a disability.

Respite provides families with an opportunity to address other needs such as completing errands, attending to housework, spending time with their other children or taking some time for selfcare.

Respite support cannot be used to cover work, training or education-related childcare needs for parents. Childcare in these situations may be provided in an FSCD agreement but requires an assessment of need.

Who can provide respite?

The respite provider can be a private person, like a trusted friend, neighbor 18 years of age or older, or a private agency. The provider can also be a community agency that provides respite services.

In unique circumstances and if approved by FSCD, an adult relative 18 years of age or older (except for a parent), or a 16- or 17-yearold individual who is not a relative may be able to provide respite support.

Respite may be provided in the family home, in the respite provider's home, or in the community.

How do I find a respite provider?

Parents are responsible for making sure the Parents are responsible for making sure the respite provider they hire is right for their child and family.

If you do not have a respite provider in mind, you may want to consider talking with:

- staff members of day-care centres, early intervention services, or schools
- health care providers
- community centres
- community and civic associations
- religious and cultural centres
- other families for suggestions
- Respite workers and volunteers within your community.

Some families choose to receive respite supports from a program or agency, which leaves the recruiting and hiring staff process to someone else.

Are There Any Hiring Tips?

Family Resource Centres are available to help families manage all aspects of their FSCD Agreement and services, including supporting families to find respite providers. Family Resource Centres can provide valuable information regarding respite, screening providers, and interview questions.

Respite providers should be genuinely caring and willing to learn about your child. Additionally, the respite provider's qualifications and skill level should match your child's level of care requirements.

When hiring a respite provider, you may want to:

- request and contact at least two (2) references
- conduct a criminal record check - contact your local police department
- request a resume, develop a simple application, or a check list for potential providers

How do I submit my claim and keep track of hours and payment?

FSCD is a **reimbursement program.**

For more record-keeping information, see our Family Guide for Financial Record-Keeping.

Contact a Family Resource Centre if you would like more information on and support with record keeping, online reimbursement, or other resources.

How Do I Orient my Respite Worker?

You know your child's likes, dislikes, and special routines (such as sleep, eating, discipline). You may be the only one who can understand what your child is attempting to communicate or what their leisure preferences are, so it is important that this information.

Having a new respite worker while a parent is at home can establish relationship building and comfort level between the child, parents, and respite worker. This allows the respite worker to learn support strategies, family routines, and expectations necessary for a consistent level of care.

What Do I Need to Know About Liability?

You may want to contact your insurance company to advise them of the presence of a respite worker in their home.

Who Should I Contact with a Concern or Complaint?

If you have any questions or concerns about your provider's actions or attitude, you are encouraged to have an open and honest discussion with them about your concerns.

You should be confident that your child is safe and be comfortable with your respite provider.

If your respite provider is not the right fit for your child or family, you may want to find a new respite provider. You can contact a Family Resource Centre if you want to discuss your concerns and get support.

Classification: Protected A

11. FAQ – Counselling

What is Counselling in the FSCD Program?

Counselling can support family well-being and strengthen their ability to care for their child. It can also help families with understanding and facing challenges with their child's disability.

There may be certain times where counselling services may be particularly beneficial, such as during:

- An initial diagnosis
- Delayed developmental milestones
- Educational transitions
- Transition to adulthood

Counselling in FSCD does not include costs related to psychological assessments or testing.

Who Can Provide Counselling?

The FSCD program assists families with the costs of individual and/or family counselling from licensed or registered providers under the *Health Professions Act.*

Visit MyHealth.Alberta.ca for more information on who can provide counselling in Alberta and tips on how to find a counsellor or therapist.

Family Resource Centres are also available to help families manage all aspects of their FSCD Agreement and services, including counselling.

Should I use Counselling Services or Coverage from other Programs before FSCD?

Guardians **must** access counselling services or coverage from other available programs first, such as Mental Health Services, benefit plans, Blue Cross, private health insurance or employee plans.

How Do I Submit my Claim and Keep Track of my Payments?

FSCD is a **reimbursement program**.

Guardians must keep receipts or other validation that they received counselling and that they paid for the service. Receipts or other validation require the provider's license/registration number. Parents must provide these records to FSCD when requested.

For more record-keeping information, see our Family Guide for Financial Record-Keeping.

Contact a Family Resource Centre if you would like more information on and support with record keeping, online reimbursement, or other resources.

Classification: Protected A

12. FAQ – Medical Appointments

What is Medical Appointment Supports in FSCD?

The costs associated with attending disability-related medical appointments can have an extraordinary financial impact on families of children with disabilities.

Families can receive support with some of the extraordinary costs related to disability-related medical or rehabilitation appointments or hospitalization, including:

- Mileage (@ $0.12 per kilometre) and public transportation
- Parking (up to $10 daily)
- Sibling care

What if we need to travel out of our community or stay overnight to attend a medical appointment?

A guardian and child can also receive coverage for meals and accommodation (if overnight stay is necessary), in addition to the supports previously mentioned such as transportation, sibling care and parking, if **eight hours or more** of travel to appointments for hospitalization directly related to the child's disability is required.

Families cannot claim reimbursement for meals for their child when the child is in the hospital.

What if we need to leave the province for medical care?

If the child requires disability related medical/rehabilitation appointments or hospitalizations outside Alberta that are funded by the Ministry of Health, assistance with the costs of meals, accommodations, sibling care, parking and mileage or transportation may be provided through FSCD.

Funding for out-of-province medical trips must be pre-approved, in writing by Alberta Health, except in the case of emergency medical evacuation.

How Do I Submit my Claim and Keep Track of Payments?

FSCD is a **reimbursement program.**

Guardians must complete the online **Confirmation of Medical Appointment/Hospital Stay Form**, keep records for mileage and receipts for other expenses (such as accommodations, parking and meals), and provide these records to FSCD when requested.

For more record-keeping information, see the Family Guide for Financial Record-Keeping.

Contact a Family Resource Centre if you would like more information on and support with record keeping, online reimbursement, or other resources.

Classification: Protected A

13. FAQ – Clothing and Footwear

How does FSCD Assist with Clothing and Footwear?

FSCD assists families with some of the **extraordinary costs** of clothing and footwear **directly related to their child's disability**.
Guardians remain responsible for their child's typical clothing and footwear expenses.

What is "Extraordinary Clothing and Footwear" for a Child with a Disability?

Assistance with extraordinary clothing and footwear costs may be considered when there is:

- Excessive wear and tear on clothing or footwear
- A need for specialized footwear
- Excessive or continual soiling of undergarments, pants or shorts for children over the age of three years
- Tearing of clothing because of behavioural issues
- Excessive drooling or damage to clothing
- A need for specialized clothing adaptation or alteration
- Additional clothing requirements where the child's weight substantially varies over a short period of time
- A need for other extraordinary clothing and/or footwear that are directly related to the child's disability that are not listed
  above

FSCD workers can assist guardians with identifying extraordinary clothing and footwear needs, such as the number and cost of each item, based on typical clothing or footwear costs.

How Do I Submit my Claim and Keep Track of Payments?

FSCD is a **reimbursement program.**

Guardians must keep receipts or other validation and provide them to FSCD when requested. Clothing items and footwear submitted for reimbursement must be clearly marked on receipts.

For more record-keeping information, see the Family Guide for Financial Record-Keeping. You can also contact a Family Resource Centre if you would like more information on and support with record keeping, online reimbursement, or other resources.

Classification: Protected A